EARLYEDGE CHECKLIST

Spring Week Conversion Checklist

The step-by-step system to prepare for, perform during, and convert your spring week into a summer internship offer.

4	60+	6
PHASES	ACTION ITEMS	DIVISION GUIDES

EarlyEdge

Phase 1: Pre-Spring Week Preparation

Start at least 4 weeks before your spring week. The work you do before you arrive is what separates candidates who convert from those who don't.

A Have the Right Conversations

4+ weeks before

- [ ] **Find 2-3 people who did your exact spring week last year** - check your university network, LinkedIn, or society alumni lists
- [ ] **Ask them how each day went** - what tasks, case studies, and presentations they did
- [ ] **Ask what they wish they had prepared** - what caught them off guard, what they would do differently
- [ ] **Ask about the conversion process** - was there an AC at the end? Fast-tracked interviews? How many people converted?
- [ ] **Ask about the social dynamics** - how many interns, how competitive was the vibe, any social events
- [ ] **Write down every insight** in a preparation document you can review the week before

EARLYEDGE TIP
Even one conversation with a previous spring weeker gives you an unfair advantage. Most candidates walk in blind.

B Build Your Technical Foundations

3-4 weeks before

- [ ] **Learn technicals to summer internship level** - not spring week level. This is what separates you
- [ ] **Don't just memorise formulas - understand application.** E.g. know that EV = Equity Value + Net Debt + Minority Interest AND how it appears in real transaction announcements
- [ ] **Prepare division-specific knowledge** (see the table below for what to focus on)
- [ ] **Practice explaining concepts out loud** - you need to articulate these in case studies and conversations
- [ ] **Work through at least 2 mock case studies** relevant to your division

DIVISION	WHAT TO KNOW
Investment Banking	Valuation methods (DCF, comps, precedent), EV/Equity bridge, M&A transaction mechanics, LBO basics, accounting fundamentals
Markets / S&T	Bond/equity pricing, derivatives (options, swaps, MBS, CDS), how market factors affect security values, desk functions
Research	Stock pitch structure, industry analysis, macro drivers, portfolio construction basics, equity vs fixed income focus
Asset Management	Portfolio allocation, diversification, risk management, hedging strategies, investment philosophies (value, growth, contrarian), 60/40 portfolio history

C Build Awareness and Prepare Questions

2-3 weeks before

- [ ] **Read up on the firm's recent transactions and deals** - know at least 3 recent pieces of work
- [ ] **Understand current market conditions** - interest rates, major indices, sector trends, central bank policy
- [ ] **Research the teams you'll be meeting** - find out which desks/groups you'll shadow (Healthcare, Tech, ECM, DCM, etc.)
- [ ] **Prepare 2-3 tailored questions per team** - specific to their recent work, not generic "what do you do" questions
- [ ] **Track 1-2 live market stories** you can reference in conversations (M&A deal, IPO, rate decision, earnings)
- [ ] **Research senior people you might meet** - LinkedIn profiles, any published articles or deals they led

EARLYEDGE TIP

Write your questions in a small notebook. Interviewers notice when you pull out prepared, specific questions. It signals genuine interest.

D Logistics and Mindset

1 week before

- [ ] **Plan your outfits for every day** - dress your smartest, no surprises on the morning
- [ ] **Map your commute and arrive 15 minutes early** - being late is an instant red flag
- [ ] **Prepare your "tell me about yourself" story** - 60-90 seconds, covering your background, why finance, and why this firm
- [ ] **Have a clear answer for "why this division"** - tie it to genuine interest, not just prestige
- [ ] **Print business cards if you have them** or ensure your LinkedIn is polished and ready to share
- [ ] **Get proper sleep the 3 nights before** - you need to be sharp, not caffeinated and anxious

COMMON MISTAKE

Most candidates prepare technicals but forget to prepare their personal story. Senior bankers remember the person, not the valuation answer. Have a compelling narrative about your journey.

Phase 2: During the Spring Week

HR is watching. Employees are forming opinions. Every interaction counts. Here's how to maximise every day.

A Daily Non-Negotiables

Every single day

- [ ] **Arrive early, dress sharp, demonstrate attention** - basics that many still get wrong
- [ ] **Take notes in every session** - and review them each evening to refresh for the next day
- [ ] **Do not speak over others** - take a moderate approach and make your contributions impactful, not frequent
- [ ] **Ask at least one thoughtful question per session** - use your prepared questions but adapt to what's been discussed
- [ ] **Stay for every social event** - this is where you build rapport with HR and employees in a relaxed setting
- [ ] **Connect with your assigned buddy/shadow** - do your research on them beforehand and ask genuine questions

B Building Relationships

Throughout the week

- [ ] **Follow up every meaningful conversation** with a LinkedIn connection request or email within 24 hours
- [ ] **Reference something specific from your conversation** in the follow-up message - shows you listened
- [ ] **Build strong rapport with HR specifically** - they often have significant input on conversion decisions
- [ ] **Be genuinely curious about people's careers** - ask about their path, not just what their team does
- [ ] **Remember names** - write them down if you need to. Using someone's name when you see them again is powerful
- [ ] **Be kind and collaborative with other spring weekers** - competitiveness is noticed negatively

C Evening Reflection Routine

30 mins each evening

- [ ] **Review your notes** from the day's sessions
- [ ] **Write down names and key details** of everyone you spoke to
- [ ] **Draft follow-up messages** for LinkedIn/email
- [ ] **Prepare questions for tomorrow's sessions** based on what you learned today
- [ ] **Note anything you want to improve** for the next day (spoke too much, too little, missed an opportunity)

Phase 3: The Conversion Assessment Centre

The format varies by firm: some have ACs on the last day, others a few weeks after, others fast-track you to next year's process. Be ready for all components.

A Group Case Study

- [ ] **Read the instructions independently first** - think about your strengths before diving in as a group
- [ ] **Volunteer for sections that match your strengths** - split the work for efficiency
- [ ] **Be critical of information** - not everything in the pack is relevant. Time efficiency is key
- [ ] **Share findings with the group and discuss critically** - challenge ideas constructively
- [ ] **Run through the full presentation once as a team** before presenting
- [ ] **When presenting: stay calm, use notes, support teammates** who need help
- [ ] **Know the weaknesses in your thesis** - assessors will probe them. Anticipate counterarguments

B Senior Interviews

- [ ] **Expect curveballs** - "Should we tax charities?", "Do you have what it takes?", "What would you advise our CEO?"
- [ ] **Have a compelling personal story** - what makes you unique? Why are you here? Sell your journey like a banker sells a deal
- [ ] **Give answers that invite follow-up questions** - make your responses interesting enough that they want to dig deeper
- [ ] **Turn interviews into conversations** - ask the MD about their career, their leadership philosophy, what they wish they knew
- [ ] **Reference what you learned during the spring week** - shows you paid attention and you're already bought in
- [ ] **Prepare for standard technicals** - valuation, market awareness, accounting, brain teasers (division-dependent)

QUESTIONS TO ASK SENIOR INTERVIEWERS

"Was there a specific person or moment that shaped your career?"
"What's your personal leadership philosophy?"
"What do you wish you knew when you started, and how would it have changed things?"

C Maths Test (if applicable)

- [ ] **Expect: basic operations, data interpretation, applied finance calculations**
- [ ] **Practice mental maths daily** in the 2 weeks before - percentages, ratios, quick multiplication
- [ ] **For markets roles: practice estimation questions** - "How long is a train from London to Edinburgh?" Think out loud, explain your reasoning

Division-Specific AC Focus Areas

What to prioritise depending on your division.

DIVISION	CASE STUDY FOCUS	INTERVIEW FOCUS
Investment Banking	Transaction analysis, M&A deal rationale, valuation application, group presentations	Technical questions, deal discussion, "why IB", personal story, curveball opinions
Markets / S&T	Trade ideas, portfolio construction given macro conditions, risk scenarios	Market awareness, brain teasers, mental maths, "pitch me a trade", estimation questions
Equity Research	Stock pitch, industry analysis, investment portfolio for a client given current conditions	Commercial awareness, stock picks, sector drivers, clarity of presentation
Fixed Income Research	Bond-focused portfolio construction, macro environment analysis, asset class recommendations	Bond fundamentals, yield curves, rate sensitivity, macro views
Asset Management	Portfolio allocation for different investor profiles, diversification, hedging strategies	Investment philosophy, correlation/expected returns, benchmark comparisons, major AM fund strategies

Phase 4: After the Spring Week

The spring week ends but the conversion process doesn't. What you do in the days and weeks after matters.

A Immediate Follow-Up

Within 48 hours

- [ ] **Send thank-you emails to HR, your buddy, and anyone who gave you significant time**
- [ ] **Connect with every employee you spoke to on LinkedIn** with a personalised note
- [ ] **Connect with fellow spring weekers** - these are your future network in the industry
- [ ] **Write a full debrief while it's fresh** - what went well, what you'd improve, key learnings

B Ongoing Relationship Building

Weeks and months after

- [ ] **Keep in touch with your key contacts** - send relevant articles, congratulate them on deals, check in quarterly
- [ ] **If you don't convert immediately, stay on their radar** - politely follow up with HR on next steps
- [ ] **Apply what you learned** - whether it's technicals, networking skills, or market awareness, keep building
- [ ] **Prepare for the full internship application** if you're fast-tracked rather than given an immediate offer

Want coaching from someone who actually converted?

EarlyEdge connects you with students who converted their spring weeks at top firms. Get 1-on-1 coaching, mock interviews, and firm-specific preparation.

Book a Coaching Session

✓ 1-on-1 with a converter ✓ Firm-specific prep ✓ Mock case studies ✓ Interview practice